

The value we created

A more welcoming home for poetry, people and creative possibility



The journal's courtyard artwork: an invitation to enter, pause and read.

Kabita Live already held a rich literary world: its poems, editors, contributors and years of publication. Our work gives that world a more welcoming digital home, where readers can discover its depth and spend time with its writing.

I directed the redesign with AI assistance in research, design, implementation and checking. We studied the publication, compared alternatives, refined small details and preserved the material behind our decisions. The care lies both in what readers see and in the work that supports it.

The result connects the magazine's history with its creative possibilities. Readers have more ways to explore; poets have more context around their work; editors have a shared foundation to develop.

How we arrived here

29 September - 2 October 2026 | Dates in Pacific Time

A concentrated period of research, design and review

We worked through repeated comparisons, content checks and reader tests. The dates below mark recorded milestones; they do not represent measured working hours.

29 September

Study, design and preservation

Studied the existing magazine and prepared the design proposal. Established the visual direction, captured 47 editions and 801 poem records, and connected the contributor pages.

30 September

Reading experiments and editorial preparation

Refined typography and artwork, tested reader controls and translation drafts, and created the Facebook presence. Developed supporting material for editors while preserving original content.

1 October

Profile research and page review

Completed and applied all 427 enriched poet narratives. Refined poem, poet and archive experiences through review. Investigated missing content and kept unresolved evidence visible.

2 October

Final refinements and hosted preview

Refined quiet reading and credits, resolved further writer-audit findings, and verified the hosted preview. Prepared this story for sharing; portrait review and editorial checks continue.

The effort combined human direction with AI-assisted research, design and implementation. Revisions and checks helped turn proposals into a working publication preview.

A recognisable literary character

A sense of place, with room for three languages



[Current issue](#) [Poems](#) [Poets](#) [Editors](#) [Archive](#)

SEPTEMBER 2026 · ISSUE 47 · 16 POEMS

ମାଟିର ମହକ
ମନର ସ୍ୱର

*The fragrance of earth.
The voice of the heart.*

[Read this edition](#)

Monthly poetry · Odia, Hindi & English

*"Poetry is an echo,
asking a shadow to dance."*



LIFE AS IT IS

A poem to begin with.

[All poems](#)

The homepage combines the journal's identity, artwork and an invitation to the current edition.

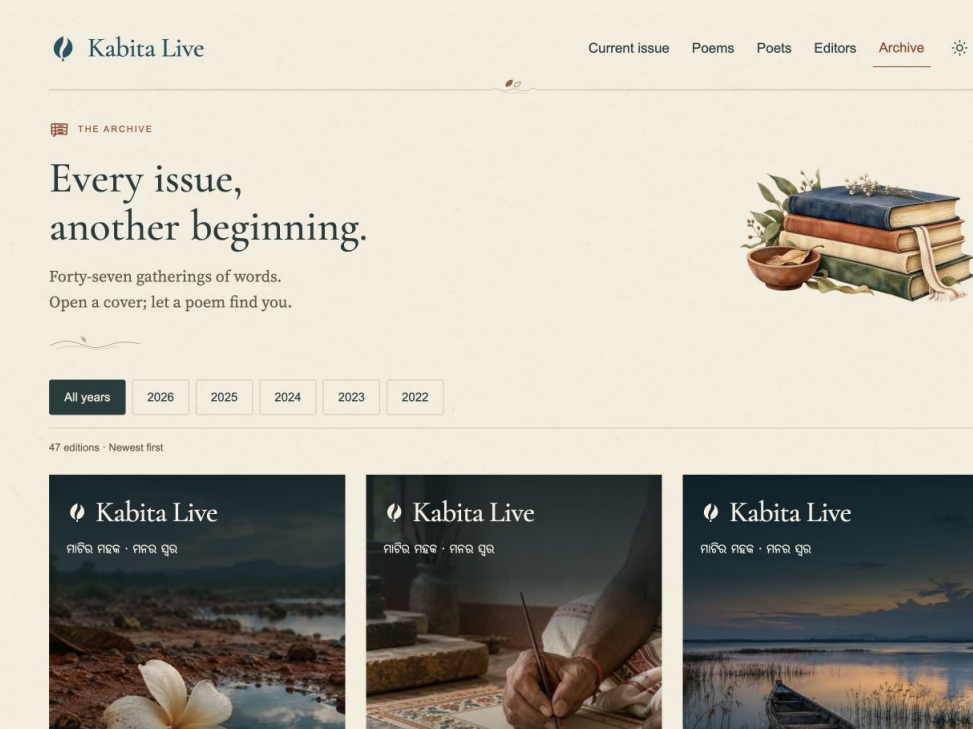
The English masthead and Odia signature keep the journal's identity clear. Warm paper, deep ink, laterite colour and artwork rooted in Odisha give the pages a consistent character. Each edition can have its own visual story within that shared language.

Typography serves the writing in Odia, Hindi and English. We considered line breaks, stanza spacing, long passages and small screens. Repeated comparisons helped us remove clutter and give poems, names and images the space they need.

This creates continuity for readers and a reusable design foundation for editors. Future covers and illustrations can respond to new poems while still feeling part of Kabita Live.

More paths into the poetry

The archive and poet profiles make the magazine's connections visible



A connected archive gives earlier writing new opportunities to find readers.

47
EDITIONS

799
ACTIVE POEMS

427
ENRICHED PROFILES

We connected poems with their editions and contributors, investigated incomplete entries and repaired combined or duplicated content. Of 801 captured poem records, two unavailable entries remain preserved outside active editions. The archive gives earlier work a place in the continuing life of the journal.

The 427 enriched poet narratives add literary background and contribution history. Identity checks, faithful quotations and careful use of evidence help readers meet the person behind a poem. A few identity and credit questions remain for editorial confirmation.

Together, these connections support discovery across issues and authors. They also give editors material for themed selections, rediscoveries and introductions that can bring an older poem to a new audience.

Room to stay with a poem

Reading features support attention, return visits and personal exploration

Quiet reading mode gives the poem the main space.

Adjustable text, light and dark appearances, search and bookmarks offer readers different ways to enter and return to the writing. Saved marks and bookmarks stay on the reader's device.

Poet profiles and artistic portraits add a human presence beside the work. The portrait treatment draws from existing photographs, while preserving originals. The wider portrait collection continues through review.

These features create better conditions for reflection and discovery. Their value will deepen through editorial care and reader feedback; we have not yet measured changes in engagement.



Narmada Nilotpala

An artistic portrait based on an existing photograph.

← Exit reading

🔖 Aa

pouring out from my restless pores
all night.
At daybreak I am convinced
that nothingness
can be converted into thingness
though it needs a lot of love
for undeterred pain and resolute anguish.

Mrittika



Anindita Bose

At twilight I received a gift from you
a space that you have been creating
for a long time,
perhaps it was never meant for me
but most things on earth are predestined

I waited up there with a hope to listen

the stories of life and beyond,
the space that belongs to you has a
mystic essence that every human shall
experience soon...

Yet today when I was there I felt a kind
of selfless love that is carried by old souls
to spread the light and wisdom

You have the power to share with the world
the dreams that most humans wish to fulfill,
your pains and scratches have turned into
the pillars of others' destinies...

I am a soul just passing by yet I stopped at
your grounded farm, to meet the cat and
the dog, to rejuvenate my own visions...
I am a healer and I need a space where I
can be my true bare self...

←

22-23

→

Quiet reading: "Mrittika" by Anindita Bose, Issue 47.

More energy for the creative work

A shared foundation helps editors carry the magazine forward



Less reinvention

Reusable page designs, an editor cheat sheet and a fuller design guide give the team a common reference. Routine presentation choices need less rethinking, leaving more room for selecting poems and working with writers.

Continuity and care

We preserved original artwork, research, source material and design decisions. These records help future changes respect the publication's history and make the work easier to understand and maintain.

A stronger basis for engagement

The Facebook presence and website sharing links give editors places to introduce poems and invite readers into the magazine. A thoughtful excerpt or an editor's reflection can become an entry point to the full work.

More ways to bring poetry to life

Ideas for editors to shape around the magazine and its contributors



Conversations across the archive

Curate poems around rain, memory, migration or belonging. Place writing from different editions and languages beside one another, with a short editorial introduction.

The poet behind the poem

Invite writers to share how a poem began, an influence or a difficult creative choice. These small reflections can deepen the encounter between poet and reader.

Collaboration across forms

Pair poems with commissioned artwork, reviewed translations or carefully produced readings. Translation drafts still need editorial review; audio remains an idea to revisit with the right quality and permissions.

Readers as thoughtful participants

Use private feedback to learn what moves readers and what they want to explore. Editors can draw on those responses while retaining their own literary judgment.

A home that can keep growing

The foundation is available for editors, poets and readers to explore



The redesigned Kabita Live is hosted and available to review and share. The preview brings the archive, enriched profiles, artwork and reading features together. The existing domain remains unchanged; the domain transition is a separate step.

The creative opportunity is to use this foundation with intention: introduce an overlooked poem, invite a writer's reflection, or shape a conversation across languages. Each choice can give the magazine another way to connect with its readers.

Editors retain literary judgment, and poets retain their voices and rights. Technology supports preparation, discovery and experimentation. The meaning comes from the people and the work they choose to share.

Explore Kabita Live

ahimanikya.github.io/kabita-live

Design direction: Ahimanikya Satapathy, with AI assistance. Poetry belongs to its authors. With acknowledgement to the editors and contributors, and to Sonu Swayin and Versatile IT Services Pvt. Ltd. for hosting and managing Kabita Live since inception. Illustrations include existing AI-assisted journal artwork.